SPECIFIER'S GUIDE · RETURNABLE STEEL RACKS

HOW TO SPEC A RETURNABLE RACK.

Everything to nail down before you request a quote — so you get the right rack the first time.

A returnable rack is only as good as the spec behind it. Pin down the part, the load plan, and the freight loop up front, and you get a rack that protects the part, ships dense, and comes back trip after trip — instead of a redesign two months in. This guide walks through what to gather, then hands you a one-page checklist you can send straight to us for a real number.

INSIDE THIS GUIDE

Why it matters: most rack do-overs trace back to a spec gap — a heaviest-part weight nobody captured, a truck that won't cubic out, an empty-return footprint that eats the savings. Five minutes of spec work up front is the cheapest engineering you'll ever do.

ISO 9001 · CAGE 2W654 · Established 1982 · 40+ Years, 4th-Gen · Byron, GA

THE FIVE THINGS

WHAT TO NAIL DOWN

01 THE PART

Start with what the rack has to hold. Capture overall size (L × W × H), the **heaviest** part's weight, how it sits (orientation), and any fragile or finish-critical surfaces that can't touch steel.

PRO TIP: spec the heaviest and the most awkward part, not the average — the rack has to carry the worst case.

02 THE LOAD PLAN

How many parts per rack, and per layer? Note any separators or dunnage between parts, whether racks **stack, nest, or fold**, and the empty-return footprint — how much air you ship home matters as much as the loaded trip.

PRO TIP: a rack that folds or nests empty can cut return freight dramatically. Flag it early.

03 THE LOGISTICS & FREIGHT LOOP

Give us annual volume or number of trips, your ship-from and ship-to lanes, and the truck, trailer, or container the rack has to fit. Tell us who owns the returnable loop and how racks cycle back.

PRO TIP: design to the trailer. Sizing a rack to cube out the truck is where the real freight savings live.

04 HANDLING & ENVIRONMENT

How is it moved — forklift, pallet jack, crane? Note load/unload height for ergonomics, whether it lives indoors or out, and any wash, heat, or corrosive exposure. That drives material and finish (powder coat vs. wet paint, carbon vs. stainless).

PRO TIP: if an operator handles it every cycle, ergonomics isn't optional — it's throughput and injury cost.

05 THE RETURNABLE PAYBACK

Estimate expected trips and service life, and compare cost per trip against expendable packaging plus the transit damage it lets through. A returnable rack that runs hundreds of trips usually pays back fast — and ours can be repaired and refurbished to extend it further.

PRO TIP: count damage and scrap, not just packaging cost — that's where returnable racks win biggest.

COPY THIS, FILL IT IN, SEND IT

YOUR RACK SPEC CHECKLIST

Have most of these and we can start a concept. You don't need every line — even a photo and a couple of dimensions gets us going.

- ☐ **Part(s) the rack holds —** print, CAD, or a clear photo
- ☐ **Part size & weight —** especially the heaviest part
- ☐ **Parts per rack / per shipment —** or we'll help you figure it
- ☐ **Annual volume or number of trips —** how hard the rack works
- ☐ **Ship-from & ship-to lanes —** and the truck / trailer / container
- ☐ **Returnable or one-way? —** stack / nest / fold requirements
- ☐ **Handling & environment —** forklift vs. pallet jack; indoor / outdoor
- ☐ **Current pain —** transit damage, ergonomics, a supplier falling short
- ☐ **Timing —** a current need or an upcoming launch date

LET'S TALK RACKS

SEND IT TO US. WE'LL QUOTE IT.

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